

COMPLETE CHESS LEARNING LIBRARY

The Complete English Opening

Symmetrical, Reversed Sicilian, closed, Hedgehog, and transpositional play

COURSE BOOK

20 focused chapters - model positions - decision rules - retrieval practice

Designed to change what you notice, calculate, remember, and do at the board.

How to Use This Course

ONE CHAPTER, FOUR PASSES

1. Read the position without moving pieces. 2. State your plan and the opponent's counterplay. 3. Study the decision rules. 4. Close the book and reconstruct the position from memory.

RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

Review the chapter the next day, one week later, and after a game that reaches a similar structure. Retrieval is more valuable than rereading.

BOARD ROUTINE

Opponent's threat - forcing moves - loose pieces - worst piece - central break - best reply - choose and stop.

The course book explains each model position. The separate workbook forces recall, prediction, and self-scoring. Use the book first, then attempt the matching workbook page without looking back.

Engine evaluations are intentionally not the lesson. The aim is to store human decision rules that remain useful when the exact move order changes.

Course Map

MODULE	CHAPTERS
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01. Symmetrical English - Move Order



01 - Symmetrical Systems

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Symmetrical English structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black can match White's setup or strike first with ...d5.

REFERENCE LINE 1. c4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Symmetrical English.

01. Decision Framework

Symmetrical English - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Symmetrical English.

02. Symmetrical English



01 - Symmetrical Systems

READ THE POSITION

Both sides mirror queenside space and delay the central commitment.

PRIMARY PLAN

Break symmetry with d4, e3, or a queenside expansion only when development supports it.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black can match White's setup or strike first with ...d5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. c4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. g3 g6 4. Bg2 Bg7

MEMORY RULE

In symmetrical positions, the first useful break matters more than the first move.

02. Decision Framework

Symmetrical English

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
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CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: In symmetrical positions, the first useful break matters more than the first move.

03. English Four Knights - Move Order



02 - Reversed Sicilian

READ THE POSITION

Reach the English Four Knights structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...e4, ...Bxc3, or ...d5 to challenge White's flexibility.

REFERENCE LINE

1. c4 e5 2. Nc3 Nf6 3. Nf3

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward English Four Knights.

03. Decision Framework

English Four Knights - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
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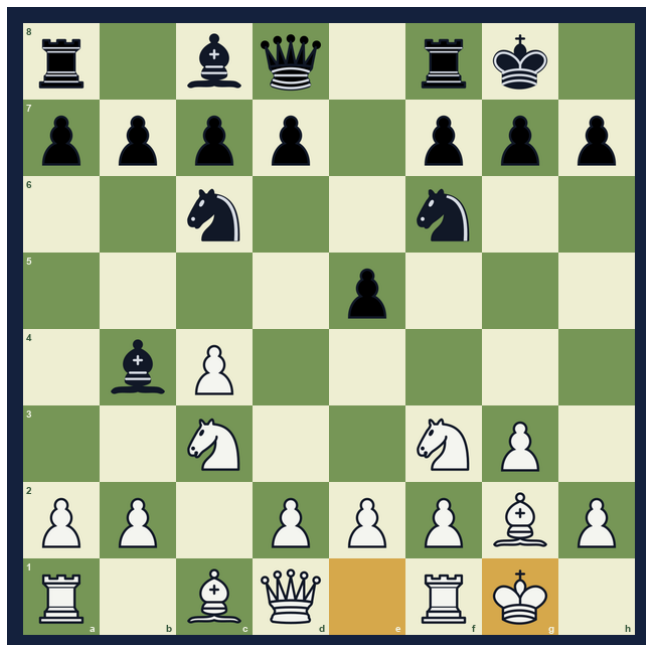
ACTIVE RECALL

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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward English Four Knights.

04. English Four Knights



02 - Reversed Sicilian

READ THE POSITION

White has a Sicilian structure with an extra tempo, but Black develops naturally and pressures the center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use d4 or Nd5 after completing development and watch the c3 pin.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...e4, ...Bxc3, or ...d5 to challenge White's flexibility.

REFERENCE LINE

1. c4 e5 2. Nc3 Nf6 3. Nf3 Nc6 4. g3 Bb4 5. Bg2 O-O 6. O-O

MEMORY RULE

The extra tempo helps only when it supports a concrete central plan.

04. Decision Framework

English Four Knights

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
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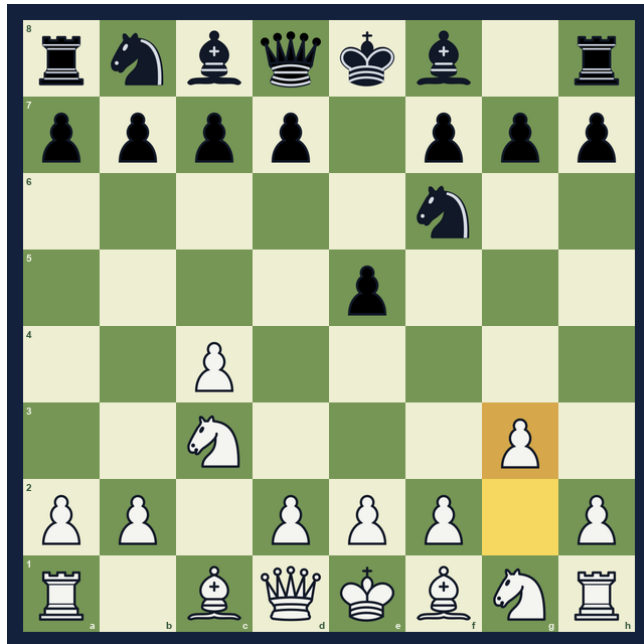
ACTIVE RECALL

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3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The extra tempo helps only when it supports a concrete central plan.

05. Reversed Dragon - Move Order



02 - Reversed Sicilian

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Reversed Dragon structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses central space and active development to neutralize White's extra tempo.

REFERENCE LINE

1. c4 e5 2. Nc3 Nf6 3. g3

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Reversed Dragon.

05. Decision Framework

Reversed Dragon - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

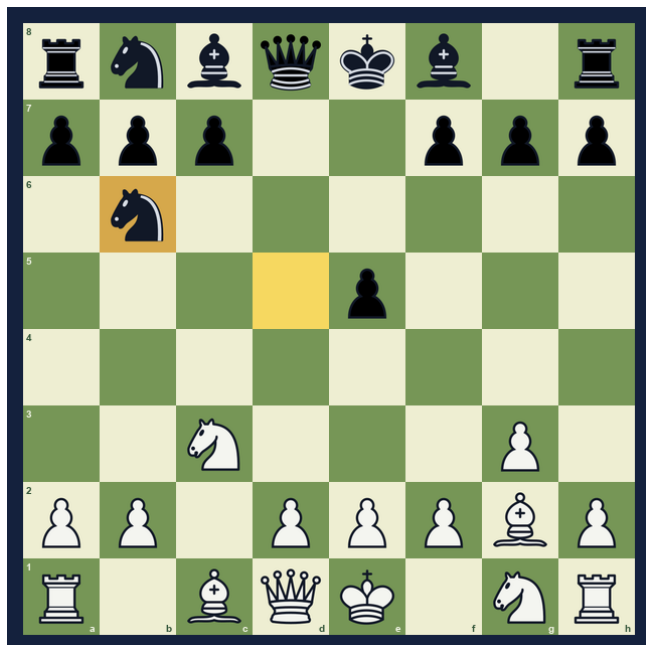
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Reversed Dragon.

06. Reversed Dragon



02 - Reversed Sicilian

READ THE POSITION

The open center resembles a Sicilian Dragon with colors reversed.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop quickly, pressure the long diagonal, and choose d3 or Nf3 according to Black's center.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses central space and active development to neutralize White's extra tempo.

REFERENCE LINE

1. c4 e5 2. Nc3 Nf6 3. g3 d5 4. cxd5 Nxd5 5. Bg2 Nb6

MEMORY RULE

In the Reversed Dragon, development and central control outrank automatic flank play.

06. Decision Framework

Reversed Dragon

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: In the Reversed Dragon, development and central control outrank automatic flank play.

07. Botvinnik Setup - Move Order



03 - Closed English

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Botvinnik Setup structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black attacks d4, expands on the queenside, or prepares ...f5.

REFERENCE LINE 1. c4 e5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. g3

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Botvinnik Setup.

07. Decision Framework

Botvinnik Setup - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

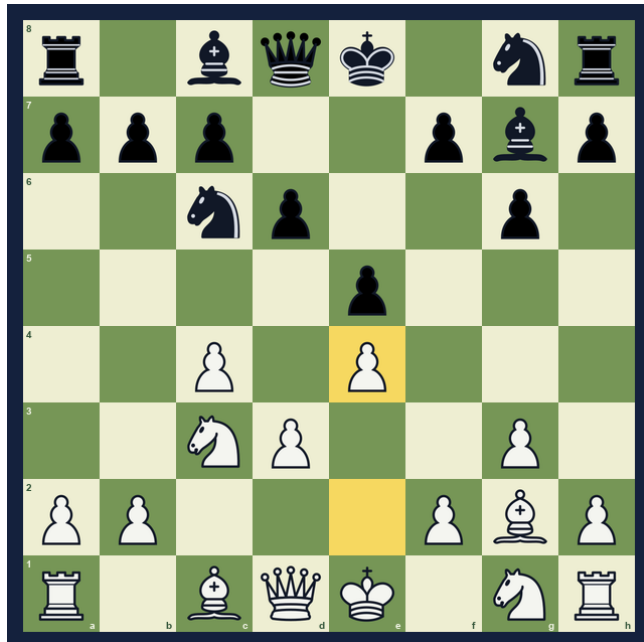
ACTIVE RECALL

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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Botvinnik Setup.

08. Botvinnik Setup



03 - Closed English

READ THE POSITION

White fixes a dark-square chain and gains kingside space while conceding d4.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use Nge2, O-O, and f4 only after securing d4 and the king.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black attacks d4, expands on the queenside, or prepares ...f5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. c4 e5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. g3 g6 4. Bg2 Bg7 5. d3 d6 6. e4

MEMORY RULE

The Botvinnik setup is a structure, not a script: protect d4 before attacking.

08. Decision Framework

Botvinnik Setup

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
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CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
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NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The Botvinnik setup is a structure, not a script: protect d4 before attacking.

09. English Hedgehog - Move Order



04 - Hedgehog

READ THE POSITION

Reach the English Hedgehog structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black waits for ...d5 or ...b5 and tactical pressure on the central files.

REFERENCE LINE

1. c4 Nf6 2. Nc3 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. g3

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward English Hedgehog.

09. Decision Framework

English Hedgehog - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
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ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
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5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward English Hedgehog.

10. English Hedgehog



04 - Hedgehog

READ THE POSITION

Black accepts less space for flexible pawn breaks and active piece squares.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use space to improve pieces and restrain ...d5 or ...b5 before expanding.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black waits for ...d5 or ...b5 and tactical pressure on the central files.

REFERENCE LINE

1. c4 Nf6 2. Nc3 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. g3 Bb7 5. Bg2 Be7 6. O-O O-O 7. d4 c5

MEMORY RULE

Against the Hedgehog, restriction comes before expansion.

10. Decision Framework

English Hedgehog

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
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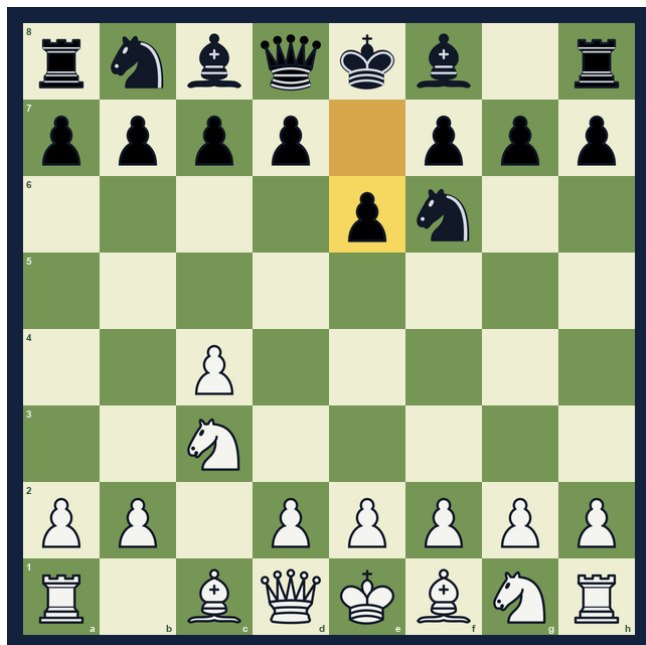
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the Hedgehog, restriction comes before expansion.

11. Mikenas Attack - Move Order



05 - Early e4 Systems

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Mikenas Attack structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...c5, ...Bb4, and ...f6 to undermine the pawn chain.

REFERENCE LINE

1. c4 Nf6 2. Nc3 e6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Mikenas Attack.

11. Decision Framework

Mikenas Attack - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
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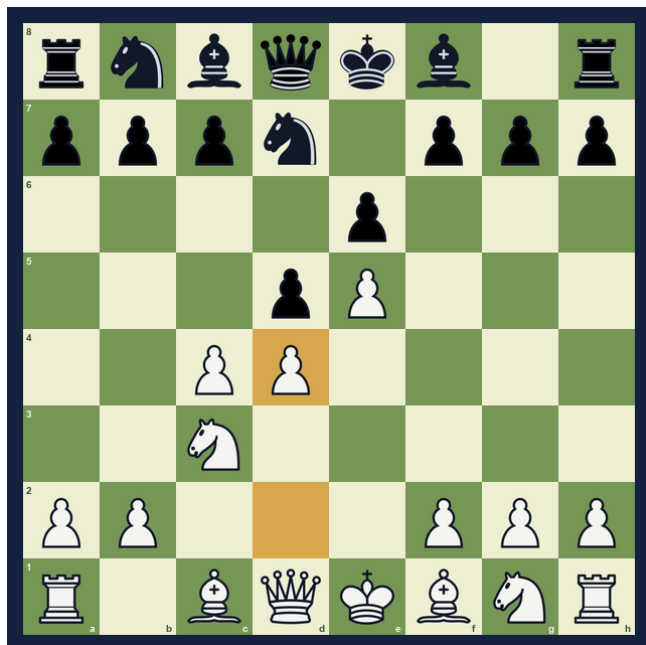
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Mikenas Attack.

12. Mikenas Attack



05 - Early e4 Systems

READ THE POSITION

White builds a broad center and gains space while accepting that Black will attack it.

PRIMARY PLAN

Support e5, complete development, and calculate every central exchange.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...c5, ...Bb4, and ...f6 to undermine the pawn chain.

REFERENCE LINE 1. c4 Nf6 2. Nc3 e6 3. e4 d5 4. e5 Nfd7 5. d4

MEMORY RULE

A large center is strong only when every pawn break has been anticipated.

12. Decision Framework

Mikenas Attack

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
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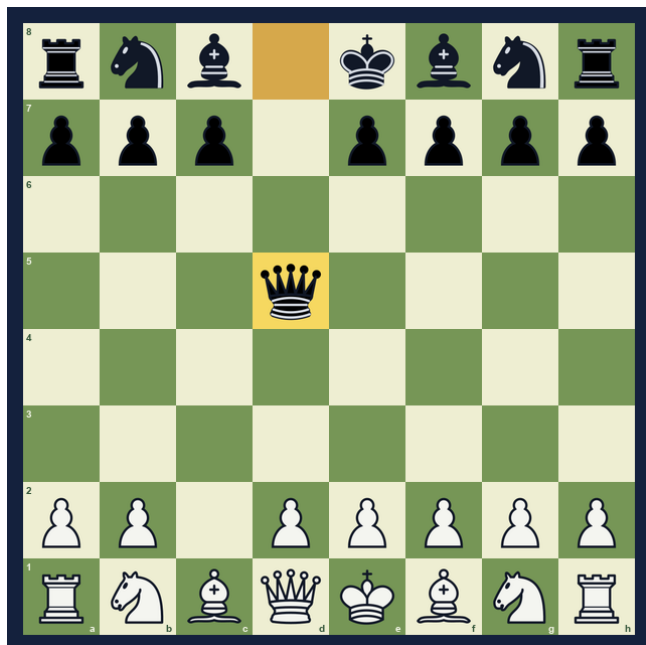
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: A large center is strong only when every pawn break has been anticipated.

13. Anglo-Scandinavian - Move Order



06 - Early Central Challenges

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Anglo-Scandinavian structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black returns the queen, develops, and challenges the expanded center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Qxd5

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Anglo-Scandinavian.

13. Decision Framework

Anglo-Scandinavian - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
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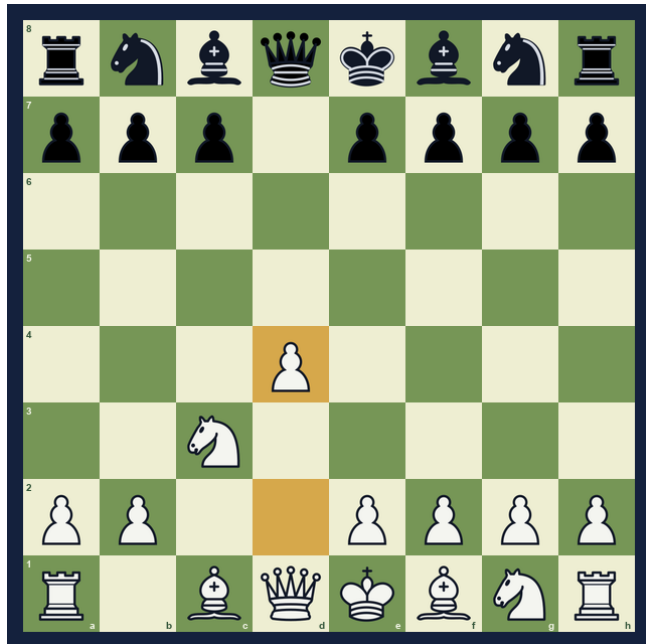
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Anglo-Scandinavian.

14. Anglo-Scandinavian



06 - Early Central Challenges

READ THE POSITION

Black's early queen recapture gives White development but removes the c-pawn tension.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop with tempo and claim the center without chasing the queen excessively.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black returns the queen, develops, and challenges the expanded center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Qxd5 3. Nc3 Qd8 4. d4

MEMORY RULE

Take the development gain, then play the position instead of continuing a queen hunt.

14. Decision Framework

Anglo-Scandinavian

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Take the development gain, then play the position instead of continuing a queen hunt.

15. Symmetrical d4 Break - Move Order



01 - Symmetrical Systems

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Symmetrical d4 Break structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses the active d5-knight and rapid development to equalize.

REFERENCE LINE

1. c4 c5 2. Nf3 Nf6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Symmetrical d4 Break.

15. Decision Framework

Symmetrical d4 Break - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Symmetrical d4 Break.

16. Symmetrical d4 Break



01 - Symmetrical Systems

READ THE POSITION

Black breaks symmetry in the center before White commits the g-pawn.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop, challenge d5, and choose d4 only when the recapture improves coordination.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses the active d5-knight and rapid development to equalize.

REFERENCE LINE 1. c4 c5 2. Nf3 Nf6 3. Nc3 d5 4. cxd5 Nxd5 5. e3

MEMORY RULE

Central symmetry breaks should be evaluated by the resulting piece activity.

16. Decision Framework

Symmetrical d4 Break

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Central symmetry breaks should be evaluated by the resulting piece activity.

17. King's English with f4 - Move Order



03 - Closed English

READ THE POSITION

Reach the King's English with f4 structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black counters with ...exf4, ...f5, or queenside expansion.

REFERENCE LINE

1. c4 e5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. g3

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward King's English with f4.

17. Decision Framework

King's English with f4 - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward King's English with f4.

18. King's English with f4



03 - Closed English

READ THE POSITION

White gains kingside space in a closed center and prepares pressure on f5 and e5.

PRIMARY PLAN

Castle, coordinate the queen and knight, and time f5 only when the center stays closed.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black counters with ...exf4, ...f5, or queenside expansion.

REFERENCE LINE

1. c4 e5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. g3 g6 4. Bg2 Bg7 5. d3 d6 6. f4

MEMORY RULE

A wing attack is sound when the center is fixed and the king is secure.

18. Decision Framework

King's English with f4

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: A wing attack is sound when the center is fixed and the king is secure.

19. Agincourt Structure - Move Order



07 - d4 Transpositions

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Agincourt Structure structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black challenges the center with ...c5 or captures on c4.

REFERENCE LINE

1. c4 e6 2. Nf3 d5 3. g3

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Agincourt Structure.

19. Decision Framework

Agincourt Structure - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

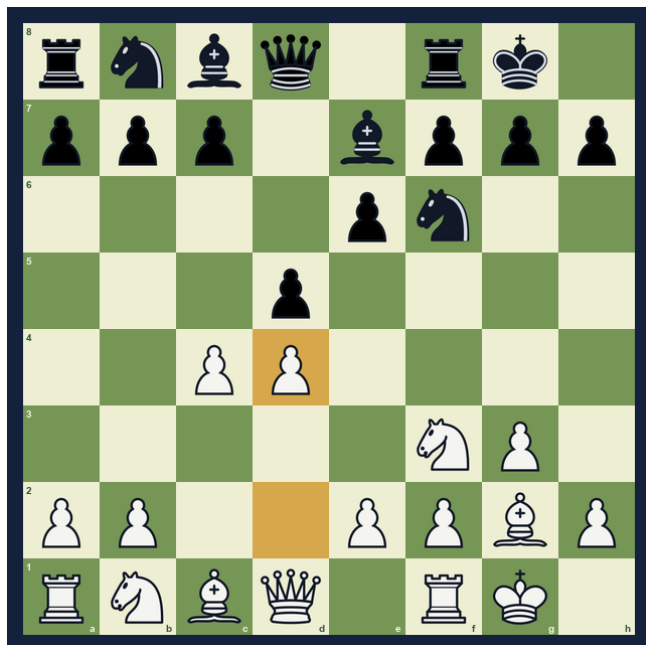
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Agincourt Structure.

20. Agincourt Structure



07 - d4 Transpositions

READ THE POSITION

The English transposes toward Catalan and Queen's Gambit structures.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use cxd5 or d4 according to piece placement and avoid forcing an English-only plan.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black challenges the center with ...c5 or captures on c4.

REFERENCE LINE

1. c4 e6 2. Nf3 d5 3. g3 Nf6 4. Bg2 Be7 5. O-O O-O 6. d4

MEMORY RULE

The board's structure is more important than the opening label.

20. Decision Framework

Agincourt Structure

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The board's structure is more important than the opening label.

Course Completion Test

Choose ten chapters at random. Rebuild each reference position, name both sides' plans, identify the critical break, and state the trade filter without reopening the chapter.

Score one point for the structure, one for your plan, one for counterplay, one for the break, and one for the memory rule. Forty out of fifty means the knowledge is usable; below forty means retrieval practice should continue.

FINAL PRINCIPLE

A course is complete when its ideas appear in your decisions, not when its pages have been read.